



Appeals Policy & Procedures

Overleaf Publishers Ltd — Chainsaw Courses Platform

Document Ref	Version	Issue Date	Next Review
Appeals Policy	1.0	July 2026	July 2027

1 | Policy Statement

Overleaf Publishers Ltd is committed to ensuring that all assessment decisions are fair, consistent, and made in accordance with the Assessment Policy. Where a learner believes that an assessment decision was incorrect, unfair, or not made in accordance with published procedures, they have the right to appeal. This policy sets out the grounds, process, and timescales for submitting and determining appeals.

2 | Grounds for Appeal

An appeal may be submitted on one or more of the following grounds:

- The assessment was not conducted in accordance with the published Assessment Policy or procedures
- A specific examination or quiz question was inaccurate, ambiguous, or contained an incorrect stated answer
- The learner experienced a technical failure on the platform that adversely affected their assessment performance, which was not resolved at the time
- The learner's reasonable adjustment request was not applied correctly
- The learner believes an assessment result was recorded incorrectly due to a platform or administrative error

The following are NOT valid grounds for appeal:

- Dissatisfaction with a fair result that correctly reflects the learner's performance
- Requests to re-sit without completing additional study
- Appeals submitted after the deadline without valid extenuating circumstances

3 | Appeals Process

Stage	Action	Timescale
Stage 1	Informal resolution — learner contacts info@chainsawcourses.com with details of their concern. The Managing Director will review and respond informally.	Within 5 working days of contact
Stage 2	Formal appeal — if the informal response is unsatisfactory, the learner submits a written formal appeal stating the specific grounds, evidence, and outcome sought.	Appeal must be submitted within 20 working days of the original result or Stage 1 response
Stage 2	Formal appeal investigation — the Managing Director conducts a full investigation including review of the learner's assessment record, platform logs, and the specific question(s) in dispute.	Investigation completed within 15 working days of formal appeal receipt
Stage 2	Formal appeal decision — the learner receives a written decision with reasons. Where the appeal is upheld, appropriate remedial action is taken (e.g. question removed from bank, free resit offered, result corrected).	Decision issued within 20 working days of formal appeal receipt

Stage 3	External escalation — if the learner remains dissatisfied following Stage 2, the matter may be referred to IIRSM (as the approving body) for independent review. Contact details provided on request.	As per IIRSM procedures
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4 | What to Include in a Formal Appeal

- Full name and email address registered on the platform
- The specific assessment (module quiz or final examination) and the attempt date
- A clear statement of the grounds for appeal (from the list in Section 2)
- Any supporting evidence (e.g. screenshots of technical errors, platform error messages)
- The outcome you are seeking

5 | Appeal Outcomes

Following investigation, an appeal may result in:

- Dismissal — where the appeal is not upheld; the original result stands with full explanation of the decision
- Partial uphold — where the appeal identifies a valid issue but does not affect the overall result; corrective action taken on the identified issue
- Full uphold — where the appeal identifies a significant error; remedial action may include a free resit attempt, result correction, or certificate reissuance
- Question removal — where a specific question is found to be inaccurate or unfair, it is removed from the active question bank pending revision

6 | Confidentiality & Records

All appeals and their outcomes are treated confidentially and records are held for a minimum of 3 years. Appeal outcomes are reviewed annually to identify patterns that may indicate systemic issues with assessment content or platform functionality.